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Ophthalmologic device and method for controlling same

Abstract

Provided are an ophthalmologic device and a method of controlling the same capable of accurately and reliably acquiring ocular characteristics of a subject eye. The ophthalmologic device includes: a face supporting unit configured to support a face of an examinee; an anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit configured to repeatedly acquire an anterior ocular segment image of the subject eye of the face supported by the face supporting unit; a pupil image detecting unit configured to detect a pupil image of the subject eye for each anterior ocular segment image based on the anterior ocular segment image repeatedly acquired by the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit; and a determining unit configured to determine whether or not the face is properly supported by the face supporting unit based on a result of detection of the pupil image for each anterior ocular segment image by the pupil image detecting unit.

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Field of Classification Search

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) The present application is a Continuation of PCT International Application No. PCT/JP2020/037225 filed on Sep. 30, 2020, claiming priority under 35 U.S.C § 119(a) to Japanese Patent Application No. 2019-196011 filed on Oct. 29, 2019. Each of the above applications is hereby expressly incorporated by reference, in its entirety, into the present application.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

1. Field of the Invention

(1) The present invention relates to an ophthalmologic device equipped with a face supporting unit configured to support an examinee's face and a method of controlling the ophthalmologic device.

2. Description of the Related Art

(2) In ophthalmology, an ophthalmologic device acquires various ocular characteristics such as fundus photographic images, fundus tomographic images, ocular refractive power, an intraocular pressure, a number of corneal endothelial cells, and a corneal shape of a subject eye (measured, photographed, observed, and so forth). In this case, positioning, i.e., an alignment of a measurement head (optical system) of the ophthalmologic device to the subject eye, is extremely important from a viewpoint of accuracy, precision, and image quality of the ocular characteristics to be acquired. For this reason, the ophthalmologic device usually performs so-called full auto-alignment (hereinafter referred to as “auto-alignment”), which automatically performs alignment by detecting the relative position of the subject eye to the measurement head in a state where the examinee's face is supported by a face supporting unit such as a chin rest and moving the optical system with respect to the subject eye based on results of the detection.

(3) For example, Patent Literature 1 and Patent Literature 2 disclose ophthalmologic devices that simultaneously photograph an anterior ocular segment of a subject eye from different directions

from each other using a stereo camera positioned opposite to an examinee's face supported by a face supporting unit. In this ophthalmologic device, auto-alignment of the measurement head to the subject eye is performed based on the three-dimensional position of the subject eye obtained by analyzing the photographed image of the stereo camera.

CITATION LIST

(4) Patent Literature 1: Japanese Patent Application Laid-Open No. 2013-248376 Patent Literature 2: Japanese Patent Application Laid-Open No. 2014-200678

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(5) Incidentally, in a case where the examinee's face is not properly supported by a face supporting unit such as a chin rest, for example, if the examinee's face is not in contact with the chin rest, the face (the subject eye) may move during the acquisition of ocular characteristics of the subject eye. As a result, the accuracy of the acquired ocular characteristics may become low or the acquisition of ocular characteristics may fail. For example, when photographing the fundus of a subject eye, if the face moves during the photographing, blurring and flare may occur in the fundus photographic image, or the photographing may fail. These problems cannot be solved no matter how high the accuracy of auto-alignment is made.

(6) In view of such circumstances, the present invention aims to provide an ophthalmologic device capable of accurately and reliably acquiring ocular characteristics of a subject eye and a method of controlling the same ophthalmologic device.

(7) In order to achieve the object of the present invention, an ophthalmologic device includes: a face supporting unit configured to support a face of an examinee; an anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit configured to repeatedly acquire an anterior ocular segment image of a subject eye of the face supported by the face supporting unit; a pupil image detecting unit configured to detect a pupil image of the subject eye for each anterior ocular segment image based on the anterior ocular segment image repeatedly acquired by the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit; and a determining unit configured to determine whether or not the face is properly supported by the face supporting unit based on a result of detection of the pupil image for each anterior ocular segment image by the pupil image detecting unit.

(8) According to the ophthalmologic device described above, acquisition of ocular characteristics of the subject eye can be performed in a state in which the face of the examinee is properly supported by the face supporting unit.

(9) In the ophthalmologic device according to another aspect of the present invention, the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit repeatedly acquires anterior ocular segment images from a plurality of cameras configured to photograph the subject eye from different directions, and the pupil image detecting unit includes: a first detecting unit configured to detect the pupil image from the anterior ocular segment image photographed by a first camera among the plurality of cameras; an estimating unit configured to estimate a presence range of the pupil image included in the anterior ocular segment image photographed by a second camera, which is different from the first camera among the plurality of cameras, the pupil image moving in response to involuntary eye movement of the subject eye, based on a result of detection by the first detecting unit; a second detecting unit configured to detect the pupil image from within the presence range of the anterior ocular segment image photographed by the second camera based on a result of estimation by the estimating unit; and a repetition controlling unit configured to repeatedly activate the first detecting unit, the estimating unit, and the second detecting unit each time when the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit repeatedly acquires the anterior ocular segment images, and the determining unit determines whether or not the face is properly supported by the face supporting unit based on results of detection repeatedly performed by the second detecting unit. Accordingly, acquisition of ocular characteristics of the subject eye can be performed in a state in which the face of the examinee is properly supported by the face supporting unit.

(10) In the ophthalmologic device according to another aspect of the present invention, the anterior

ocular segment image acquiring unit performs: image acquisition processing for the first time for acquiring anterior ocular segment images from the first camera and the second camera which photograph the subject eye from directions different from each other; and image acquisition processing for the second and subsequent times for acquiring the anterior ocular segment image repeatedly from the second camera, and the pupil image detecting unit includes: a first detecting unit configured to detect the pupil image from the anterior ocular segment image acquired by the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit from the first camera in the first image acquisition processing; an estimating unit configured to estimate a presence range of the pupil image included in the anterior ocular segment image acquired from the second camera by the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit, the pupil image moving in response to the involuntary eye movement of the subject eye, based on a result of detection by the first detecting unit; a second detecting unit configured to detect the pupil image from within the presence range of the anterior ocular segment image acquired by the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit from the second camera based on a result of estimation by the estimating unit; and a repetition controlling unit configured to repeatedly activate the second detecting unit each time when the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit repeatedly acquires the anterior ocular segment image from the second camera in the image acquisition processing for the second and subsequent times, and the determining unit determines whether or not the face is properly supported by the face supporting unit based on results of detection repeatedly performed by the second detecting unit. Accordingly, it is possible to reduce time required for the determining unit to complete the determination.

(11) In the ophthalmologic device according to another aspect of the present invention, the determining unit determines, based on the results of detection repeatedly performed by the second detecting unit, that the face is properly supported by the face supporting unit in a case where the detection of the pupil image in the presence range continues for a certain period of time, which is determined in advance, or more, and determines that the face is not properly supported by the face supporting unit in a case where the detection of the pupil image in the presence range does not continue for the certain period of time or more. Accordingly, acquisition of ocular characteristics of the subject eye can be performed in a state in which the face of the examinee is properly supported by the face supporting unit.

(12) In the ophthalmologic device according to another aspect of the present invention, the estimating unit creates a template indicating the presence range and a shape of the pupil image from the anterior ocular segment image photographed by the first camera based on the result of detection by the first detecting unit, and the second detecting unit detects the pupil image from within the presence range of the anterior ocular segment image photographed by the second camera by template matching based on the template created by the estimating unit. This enables to simply and easily detect the pupil image from the anterior ocular segment image photographed by the second camera.

(13) In the ophthalmologic device according to another aspect of the present invention, the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit repeatedly acquires the anterior ocular segment image from one of a plurality of cameras that photograph the subject eye from directions different from each other. Thus, it is possible to determine whether or not the face is properly supported by the face supporting unit, using a single existing camera.

(14) The ophthalmologic device according to another aspect of the present invention, further includes: an ocular characteristic acquiring unit configured to acquire ocular characteristics of the subject eye through an objective lens, and an anterior ocular segment observation system configured to photograph the subject eye through the objective lens, wherein the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit repeatedly acquires the anterior ocular segment image from the anterior ocular segment observation system. Thus, it is possible to determine whether or not the face is properly supported by the face supporting unit, using a single existing camera, using an existing anterior ocular segment observation system.

(15) The ophthalmologic device according to another aspect of the present invention, further includes: an ocular characteristic acquiring unit configured to acquire ocular characteristics of the subject eye through an objective lens, an ophthalmologic device main body configured to accommodate the ocular characteristic acquiring unit; a relative movement mechanism configured to move the ophthalmologic device main body with respect to the subject eye; a relative position detecting unit configured to detect a relative position of the subject eye relative to the ophthalmologic device main body based on the anterior ocular segment image acquired by the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit; and an alignment controlling unit configured to drive the relative movement mechanism to perform alignment of the ophthalmologic device main body relative to the subject eye based on a result of detection by the relative position detecting unit. Thus, it is possible to perform processing for determining whether or not the face is properly supported by the face supporting unit and auto-alignment processing, in parallel.

(16) The ophthalmologic device according to another aspect of the present invention, further includes a notifying unit configured to notify a result of determination by the determining unit in a case where the determining unit determines that the face is not properly supported by the face supporting unit. Thus, the examiner can be notified that the face is not properly supported by the face supporting unit.

(17) The ophthalmologic device according to another aspect of the present invention, further includes a supporting position changing mechanism configured to change a face supporting position by the face supporting unit, wherein the notifying unit drives the supporting position changing mechanism to change the supporting position. Thus, the examinee can be also notified that the face is not properly supported by the face supporting unit.

(18) The ophthalmologic device according to another aspect of the present invention, further includes a supporting position changing mechanism configured to change a face supporting position by the face supporting unit; a supporting position change controlling unit configured to drive the supporting position changing mechanism and change the face supporting position in a case where the determining unit determines that the face is not properly supported by the face supporting unit, and a redetermination controlling unit configured to repeatedly activate the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit, the pupil image detecting unit, and the determining unit in a case where the face supporting position is changed by the supporting position changing mechanism. Thus, it is possible to properly support the face with the face supporting unit without any operations by the examiner or caution to the examiner, thereby reducing the examiner's time and effort.

(19) In order to achieve the object of the present invention, a method of controlling an ophthalmologic device includes: an anterior ocular segment image acquisition step of repeatedly acquiring an anterior ocular segment image of a subject eye of a face supported by a face supporting unit configured to support the face of an examinee; a pupil image detection step of detecting a pupil image of the subject eye for each anterior ocular segment image based on the anterior ocular segment image repeatedly acquired by the anterior ocular segment image acquisition step; and a determination step of determining whether or not the face is properly supported by the face supporting unit based on a result of detection of the pupil image for each anterior ocular segment image by the pupil image detection step.

(20) The present invention can accurately and reliably acquire ocular characteristics of a subject eye.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a front perspective view of an ophthalmologic device according to a first embodiment,

as seen from an examinee's side.

(2) FIG. 2 is a rear perspective view of the ophthalmologic device as seen from the examiner's side.

(3) FIG. 3 is a front view of a lens housing unit.

(4) FIG. 4 is a schematic diagram illustrating an example of a configuration of a measurement head of the ophthalmologic device.

(5) FIG. 5 is a functional block diagram of an arithmetic controlling unit according to the first embodiment.

(6) FIG. 6 is an explanatory drawing for describing a processing for detecting a pupil image by a first detecting unit.

(7) FIG. 7 is an explanatory drawing for describing creation of a template by an estimating unit.

(8) FIG. 8 is an explanatory drawing for describing a processing for detecting a pupil image from an anterior ocular segment image by a second detecting unit.

(9) FIG. 9 is an explanatory drawing illustrating an example of a display of warning information by a monitor.

(10) FIG. 10 is an explanatory drawing illustrating an example of notifying the examinee that the examinee's face is not properly supported by the face supporting unit.

(11) FIG. 11 is a flowchart showing a flow of processing for acquiring ocular characteristics from the subject eye, in particular, a face support determination processing by the ophthalmologic device according to the first embodiment.

(12) FIG. 12 is a flowchart showing a flow of processing for acquiring the ocular characteristics from the subject eye by an ophthalmologic device according to a second embodiment, in particular, a face support determination processing according to a method of controlling the ophthalmologic device of the present invention.

(13) FIG. 13 is a functional block diagram of an arithmetic controlling unit of the ophthalmologic device according to a third embodiment.

(14) FIG. 14 is a flowchart showing a flow of processing for acquiring the ocular characteristics from the subject eye by an ophthalmologic device according to a third embodiment, in particular, a face support determination processing according to a method of controlling the ophthalmologic device of the present invention.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PREFERRED EMBODIMENTS

(15) [Overall Configuration of Ophthalmologic Device According to First Embodiment]

(16) FIG. 1 is a front perspective view of an ophthalmologic device 10 according to a first embodiment, as seen from an examinee's side. FIG. 2 is a rear perspective view of the ophthalmologic device 10 as seen from an examiner's side. An X direction in the Figure is a left-right direction (the eye width direction of the subject eye E illustrated in FIG. 4) with respect to the examinee, a Y direction is an up-down direction, and a Z direction is a front-rear direction (also referred to as an operation distance direction) parallel to a front direction approaching the examinee and a rear direction moving away from the examinee.

(17) As illustrated in FIGS. 1 and 2, an ophthalmologic device 10 is a combined machine including a fundus camera and an optical coherence tomography (OCT) configured to acquire an OCT image, which is a cross-sectional image, using an optical coherence tomography. The ophthalmologic device 10 acquires (measures, photographs, observes, and so forth) a fundus photographic image and an OCT image of a fundus Ef (see FIG. 4) as ocular characteristics of the subject eye E (see FIG. 4). The ophthalmologic device 10 has a base 11, a face supporting unit 12, a mount 13, and a measurement head 14.

(18) The mount 13 is provided on the base 11. In the base 11, an arithmetic controlling unit 22 (see FIG. 4) and the like, described below, are stored.

(19) The face supporting unit 12 is provided integrally with the base 11 at a position on the front side in the Z direction of the measurement head 14. The face supporting unit 12 has a chin rest 12a and a forehead fit 12b which are positionally adjustable in the Y direction (up-down direction) and

supports the examinee's face at a position facing the main body of the ophthalmologic device such as the measurement head **14** (an objective lens **43** described below).

(20) The face supporting unit **12** is provided with a motorized lifting mechanism **12c**, which corresponds to the supporting position changing mechanism of the present invention. The motorized lifting mechanism **12c** is a known actuator such as a motor driving mechanism and changes the supporting position of the examinee's face by moving the chin rest **12a** and the forehead fit **12b** in the Y direction under the control of the arithmetic controlling unit **22** (see FIG. **4**) described below.

(21) Furthermore, the face supporting unit **12** is provided with an external fixation light **15**. The external fixation light **15** has a light source that emits a fixation light, and a position of the light source and a direction of emission of the fixation light can be adjusted arbitrarily. The external fixation light **15** is used for external fixation. External fixation is a method of visual fixation to rotate the subject eye E (see FIG. **4**) in an arbitrary direction by adjusting the position of the light source of the external fixation light **15**, or to rotate the subject eye E more largely than a case of internal fixation. Alternatively, the external fixation adjusts the direction of the subject eye E by guiding a visual line of the subject eye E or a fellow eye, when the internal fixation cannot be performed.

(22) The mount **13** is movable in the X direction and Z direction (front-rear direction and left-right direction) with respect to the base **11**. An operating unit **16** is provided on the mount **13**. The measurement head **14** is provided on the mount **13** so as to be movable in the Y direction.

(23) A motorized driving mechanism **17** (see FIG. **4**), which corresponds to the relative movement mechanism of the present invention, is provided on the mount **13**. The motorized driving mechanism **17** is a known actuator such as a motor driving mechanism and moves the mount **13** in the XZ directions and moves the measurement head **14** in the Y direction under the control of the arithmetic controlling unit **22** (see FIG. **4**) described below. This moves the measurement head **14** with respect to the subject eye E in the XYZ directions.

(24) The operating unit **16** is provided on the mount **13** at a position on the rear side (examiner's side) of the measurement head **14** in the Z direction. In the operating unit **16**, in addition to operation buttons for performing various operations of the ophthalmologic device **10**, an operation lever **16a** is provided.

(25) The operation lever **16a** is an operation member for manually moving the measurement head **14** in each of the XYZ directions. For example, when the operation lever **16a** is tilted in the Z direction (front-back direction) or the X direction (left-right direction), the above-mentioned motorized driving mechanism **17** (see FIG. **4**) moves the measurement head **14** in the Z direction or the X direction. When the operation lever **16a** is rotated around a longitudinal axis thereof, the motorized driving mechanism **17** moves the measurement head **14** in the Y direction (up-down direction) according to the direction of the rotation operation.

(26) The measurement head **14** constitutes the main body of the ophthalmologic device of the present invention. A fundus camera unit **14a** and an OCT unit **14b** illustrated in FIG. **4** below are built in the measurement head **14**. A monitor **18** is provided on a rear surface of the measurement head **14**, on a rear side (examiner's side) in the Z direction. The lens housing **19** is provided in front of the measurement head **14** on the front side (examinee's side) in the Z direction.

(27) As the monitor **18**, a touch panel type liquid crystal display device, for example, is used. This monitor **18** displays various imaging data of the subject eye E (see FIG. **4**) and input screens for various setting operations.

(28) FIG. **3** is a front view of the lens housing **19**. As illustrated in FIG. **3**, the lens housing **19** constitutes a part of the fundus camera unit **14a** (see FIG. **4**) and houses an objective lens **43** having an optical axis OA parallel to the Z direction. Also, the lens housing **19** includes eight fixation holes **19a** (also referred to as fixation lights) which are disposed at an equal interval along the circumferential direction of the objective lens **43** so as to surround the objective lens **43**. Each of

the fixation holes **19a** selectively emits a fixation light in the Z direction in response to an operation at the operating unit **16**.

(29) Each fixation hole **19a** is used for peripheral fixation and for photographing the corner angle (edge of the iris) of the subject eye E (see FIG. **4**). Peripheral fixation is a method of visual fixation to greatly rotate the subject eye E in desired directions by selectively lighting each of the fixation holes **19a**.

(30) In addition, a stereo camera **20**, which corresponds to a plurality of cameras of the present invention, is provided in front of the measurement head **14** in the vicinity of the lens housing **19**. The stereo camera **20** has a first camera **20a** and a second camera **20b**. The first camera **20a** and the second camera **20b** are disposed so as to interpose the objective lens **43** therebetween, from the left and right of the objective lens **43**, on a surface of the measurement head **14** (the surface facing the subject eye E) on the front side in the Z-direction.

(31) FIG. **4** is a schematic diagram illustrating an example of a configuration of a measurement head **14** of the ophthalmologic device **10**. As illustrated in FIG. **4**, the measurement head **14** includes a fundus camera unit **14a**, an OCT unit **14b**, the stereo camera **20**, and the arithmetic controlling unit **22**.

(32) The fundus camera unit **14a** has an optical system almost similar to that of a conventional fundus camera and acquires (photographs) various observation images of the anterior ocular segment Ea or the like of the subject eye E as well as a fundus photographic image of the fundus Ef as ocular characteristics of the subject eye E through the objective lens **43**. The OCT unit **14b** acquires an OCT image of the fundus Ef as ocular characteristics of the subject eye E through the objective lens **43** and an optical system of part of the fundus camera unit **14a**. Therefore, the fundus camera unit **14a** functions as an ocular characteristic acquiring unit and an anterior ocular segment observation system of the present invention. The OCT unit **14b** functions as the ocular characteristic acquiring unit of the present invention.

(33) The arithmetic controlling unit **22** is housed in the base **11** (or possibly in the measurement head **14**) and is an arithmetic processing device such as a personal computer or the like that performs various arithmetic processing and control processing.

(34) [Fundus Camera Unit]

(35) The fundus camera unit **14a** includes an illumination optical system **30** and an imaging optical system **50** as optical systems for acquiring an observation image of the anterior ocular segment Ea or the like and a fundus photographic image, which is a two-dimensional image representing a surface form (surface shape) of the fundus Ef.

(36) The illumination optical system **30** irradiates the fundus Ef with illumination light. The imaging optical system **50** guides a light reflected from the fundus, which is an illumination light reflected by the fundus Ef, to image pickup devices **57**, **60** which are of CMOS (Complementary Metal Oxide Semiconductor) type or CCD (Charge Coupled Device) type, for example. In addition, the imaging optical system **50** guides a signal light output from the OCT optical system **80** (OCT unit **14b**) to the fundus Ef and guides the signal beam reflected from the fundus Ef to the OCT optical system **80**.

(37) The illumination optical system **30** includes an observation light source **31**, a reflection mirror **32**, a focusing lens **33**, a visible cut filter **34**, a photographing light source **35**, mirror **36**, relay lenses **37**, **38**, an aperture **39**, a relay lenses **40**, a perforated mirror **41**, a dichroic mirror **42**, an objective lens **43**, and the like.

(38) In addition to the objective lens **43**, the dichroic mirror **42**, and the perforated mirror **41** described above, the imaging optical system **50** includes a focusing lens **51**, a mirror **52**, a half mirror **53**, an optotype display **54**, a dichroic mirror **55**, a focusing lens **56**, an image pickup device **57**, a mirror **58**, a focusing lens **59**, an image pickup device **60**, and the like.

(39) The observation light source **31** is, for example, a halogen lamp or an LED (light emitting diode) and emits observation illumination light. The observation illumination light emitted from the

observation light source **31** is reflected by the reflection mirror **32**, passes through the focusing lens **33**, and passes through the visible cut filter **34** to become near-infrared light. The observation illumination light passed through the visible cut filter **34** is once focused on the vicinity of the photographing light source **35**, is reflected by the mirror **36**, and passes through the relay lenses **37**, **38**, the aperture **39**, and the relay lenses **40**. Then, the observation illumination light is reflected at the peripheral part (region around the hole) of the perforated mirror **41**, passes through the dichroic mirror **42**, and is further refracted by the objective lens **43** to illuminate the fundus Ef.

(40) The light reflected from the fundus of the observation illumination light, is refracted by the objective lens **43**, passes through the dichroic mirror **42**, the hole formed in the center region of the perforated mirror **41**, and the focusing lens **51**, and then is reflected by the mirror **52**. Further, the light reflected from the fundus passes through the half mirror **53** and then is reflected by the dichroic mirror **55**, so as to form an image on the light receiving surface of the image pickup device **57** by the focusing lens **56**. The image pickup device **57** captures (receives) the light reflected from the fundus and outputs an imaging signal to the arithmetic controlling unit **22** described below. The arithmetic controlling unit **22** causes the monitor **18** to display various observation images based on the image signal output from the image pickup device **57**. Note that, in a case where the focus of the imaging optical system **50** is adjusted to the anterior ocular segment Ea of the subject eye E, the observation image of the anterior ocular segment Ea is displayed on the monitor **18**. On the other hand, in a case where the focus of the imaging optical system **50** is adjusted to the fundus Ef, the observation image of the fundus Ef is displayed on the monitor **18**.

(41) The photographing light source **35** emits photographing illumination light. A xenon lamp or an LED light source is used as the photographing light source **35**, for example. The photographing illumination light emitted from the photographing light source **35** irradiates the fundus Ef through the same path as the observation illumination light previously described. The light reflected from the fundus of the photographing illumination light is led to the dichroic mirror **55** through the same path as the light reflected from the fundus of the observation illumination light, passes through the dichroic mirror **55**, and then is reflected by the mirror **58**, so as form an image on the light receiving surface of the image pickup device **60** by the focusing lens **59**.

(42) The image pickup device **60** captures (receives) the light reflected from the fundus and outputs an imaging signal to the arithmetic controlling unit **22** described below. The arithmetic controlling unit **22** causes the monitor **18** to display fundus photographic image based on the imaging signal output from the image pickup device **60**. The monitor **18** displaying the various observation images and the monitor **18** displaying the fundus photographic image may be the same or may be provided separately from each other.

(43) The optotype display **54** is used for internal fixation to project the fixation light of the fixation target (bright spot image) to the subject eye E through the objective lens **43**. As the optotype display **54**, for example, a dot matrix liquid crystal display (LCD) and a matrix light emitting diode (LED) may be used. The optotype display **54** displays a fixation target. In addition, the display mode (shape, and so forth.) and display position of the fixation target may be arbitrarily set in the optotype display **54**.

(44) The fixation light of the fixation target displayed on the optotype display **54** is partly reflected by the half mirror **53**, then is projected onto the subject eye E via the mirror **52**, the focusing lens **51**, a hole in a perforated mirror **41**, a dichroic mirror **42**, and objective lens **43**. As a result, a fixation target, a visual acuity measurement target, and so forth are presented to the subject eye E through the objective lens **43**.

(45) The fundus camera unit **14a** includes a focusing optical system **70**. The focusing optical system **70** creates a split indicator for focusing (focusing) on the fundus Ef. The focusing optical system **70** includes, in addition to the previously described objective lens **43**, the dichroic mirror **42**, and the perforated mirror **41**, an LED **71**, a relay lens **72**, a split indicator plate **73**, a two-hole aperture **74**, a mirror **75**, a focusing lens **76**, and a reflecting rod **77**.

(46) The reflecting surface of the reflecting rod **77** is set in the optical path of the illumination optical system **30** in a case where focus adjustment by the focusing optical system **70** is performed. The focus light emitted from the LED **71** passes through the relay lens **72**, is separated into two light fluxes by the split indicator plate **73**, then forms an image once on the reflecting surface of the reflecting rod **77** via the two-hole aperture **74**, the mirror **75**, and the focusing lens **76**, and is reflected on the reflecting surface toward the relay lenses **40**. Further, the focus light is projected on the fundus Ef via the relay lenses **40**, the perforated mirror **41**, the dichroic mirror **42**, and the objective lens **43**.

(47) The light reflected from the fundus of the focus light passes through the objective lens **43**, the dichroic mirror **42**, and the hole of the perforated mirror **41**, then passes through the focusing lens **51**, the mirror **52**, the half mirror **53**, the dichroic mirror **55** and the focusing lens **56**, and is then photographed by the image pickup device **57**. The image pickup device **57** photographs the light reflected from the fundus of the focus light and outputs an imaging signal. This causes the split indicator to be displayed on the monitor **18** together with the observed image. The arithmetic controlling unit **22** described below analyzes the position of the split indicator and moves the focusing lens **51** and the like to automatically adjust the focus as conventionally done. The focus may also be adjusted manually by the examiner based on the split indicator displayed on the monitor **18**.

(48) The dichroic mirror **42** diverges the optical path of the OCT optical system **80** from the optical path for fundus photography. The dichroic mirror **42** reflects light in the wavelength band used for OCT measurement and transmits light for fundus photography. On the optical path of this OCT optical system **80**, in an order starting from the OCT unit **14b** side, a collimator lens unit **81**, an optical path length changing unit **82**, a galvano scanner **83**, a focusing lens **84**, a mirror **85**, a relay lens **86** are provided.

(49) The optical path length changing unit **82** includes, for example, a corner cube and a mechanism for moving the corner cube. The optical path length changing unit **82** is movable in a direction of an arrow illustrated in FIG. **4** to change the optical path length of the OCT optical system **80**. The change of the optical path length is used to correct the optical path length according to the ocular axis length of the subject eye E and to adjust the interference state.

(50) The galvano scanner **83** changes the direction of travel of the signal light passing through the optical path of the OCT optical system **80**. This allows the fundus Ef to be scanned with signal light. The galvano scanner **83** includes, for example, a galvano mirror for scanning the signal light in the X direction, a galvano mirror for scanning the signal light in the Y direction, and a mechanism for driving these mirrors independently. This allows scanning with the signal light in any direction on the XY plane.

(51) [Oct Unit]

(52) The OCT unit **14b** includes an interferometric optical system used for acquiring the OCT image of the fundus Ef. In the same manner as a publicly-known OCT apparatus, the OCT unit **14b** divides the low-coherence light into a reference light and a signal light, causes the signal light having passed through the fundus Ef to interfere with the reference light having passed through the reference light path to generate an interference light, and detects a spectral component of the interference light. The result of detection (detection signal) by the OCT unit **14b** is output to the arithmetic controlling unit **22**. Since the specific configuration of the OCT unit **14b** is a known technology (see, for example, PTL 1 described above), the specific description is omitted here.

(53) [Stereo Camera]

(54) The first camera **20a** and the second camera **20b** that constitute the stereo camera **20** photograph the anterior ocular segment Ea simultaneously (including substantially simultaneously) and continuously (take a motion picture) from directions different from each other. In this embodiment, the first camera **20a** and the second camera **20b** simultaneously and continuously photograph the anterior ocular segment Ea from the left and right directions. The signs OB in the

drawing designate the optical axes of the first camera **20a** and the second camera **20b**.

(55) The first camera **20a** continuously photographs the anterior ocular segment Ea from one of the left and right directions, and outputs an anterior ocular segment image D1, which is an observation image of the anterior ocular segment Ea (see FIG. 5) to the arithmetic controlling unit **22**. The second camera **20b** continuously photographs the anterior ocular segment Ea from the other of the left and right directions, and outputs an anterior ocular segment image D2, which is an observation image of the anterior ocular segment Ea (see FIG. 5) to the arithmetic controlling unit **22**. Note that the arrangement of the first camera **20a** and the second camera **20b** may be reversed. These anterior ocular segment images D1 and D2 are used for the face support determination (also referred to as the chin rest determination), which is a determination of whether or not the examinee's face is properly (appropriately) supported by the face supporting unit **12**, and for the auto-alignment of the measurement head **14** to the subject eye E.

(56) [Arithmetic Controlling Unit]

(57) FIG. 5 is a functional block diagram of the arithmetic controlling unit **22** according to the first embodiment. As illustrated in FIG. 5, the arithmetic controlling unit **22** has a general controlling unit **90**, a memory **92**, an image forming unit **94**, and a data processing unit **96**, and the like. In addition, the previously described the motorized lifting mechanism **12c**, the fundus camera unit **14a**, the OCT unit **14b**, the external fixation light **15**, the operating unit **16**, the motorized driving mechanism **17**, the monitor **18**, the fixation holes **19a**, the stereo camera **20**, and so forth are connected to the arithmetic controlling unit **22**.

(58) The memory **92** stores a control program to be performed by the general controlling unit **90**, image data of the OCT image, image data of the fundus image, subject eye information (including examinee information), and so forth. The memory **92** also stores the template **120**, which will be described below.

(59) The image forming unit **94**, together with the OCT unit **14b**, constitutes the ocular characteristic acquiring unit of the present invention. The image forming unit **94** analyzes the detection signal input from the OCT unit **14b** to form an OCT image of the fundus Ef. Note that the specific method of forming the OCT image is the same as that of the conventional OCT system, so the explanation is omitted here. The data processing unit **96** performs image processing or the like on the OCT image formed by the image forming unit **94**, the fundus photographic image and various observation images acquired by the fundus camera unit **14a**, and the anterior ocular segment images D1 and D2 acquired by the stereo camera **20**, and so forth.

(60) The general controlling unit **90** integrally controls the operation of each unit of the ophthalmologic device **10**. The general controlling unit **90** performs the face support determination based on the anterior ocular segment images D1 and D2 input from the stereo camera **20**. In a case where it is determined that the face is properly supported by the face supporting unit **12**, the general controlling unit **90** performs auto-alignment based on images of the anterior ocular segment D1 and D2. After the auto-alignment, the general controlling unit **90** controls the fundus camera unit **14a** and the OCT unit **14b** to acquire fundus photographic images and OCT images of the fundus Ef, and so forth. In FIG. 5, only the functions related to face support determination, auto-alignment, and acquisition of ocular characteristics (fundus photographic image and OCT image) of the subject eye E are illustrated. Because other functions are of known technology, specific illustrations are omitted.

(61) The functions of the general controlling unit **90** can be realized using various types of processors (processors). The various types of processors include Central Processing Units (CPU), Graphics Processing Units (GPU), Application Specific Integrated Circuits (ASIC), and programmable logic devices (for example, Simple Programmable Logic Device (SPLD), Complex Programmable Logic Device (CPLD), and Field Programmable Gate Arrays (FPGA)) and so forth. Note that various functions of the general controlling unit **90** may be implemented in one processor or may be implemented in a plurality of processors of the same type or of different type.

(62) When acquiring the ocular characteristics (fundus photographic image and OCT image) of the subject eye E, the general controlling unit **90** functions as the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit **100**, the pupil image detecting unit **102**, the determining unit **104**, the notification controlling unit **106**, relative position detecting unit **108**, an alignment controlling unit **110**, and the ocular characteristics acquisition controlling unit **112**. Components described as the “~unit” of the arithmetic controlling unit **22** may be replaced by “circuit”, “apparatus”, or “equipment”. In other words, those described as the “~unit” may be composed of a firmware, software, and hardware or a combination thereof.

(63) [Face Support Determination]

(64) The anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit **100** is used for both face support determination and auto-alignment, and functions as image input interface wired or wirelessly connected to each of the first camera **20a** and the second camera **20b** of the stereo camera **20**. The anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit **100** acquires anterior ocular segment images **D1** and **D2** respectively from the first camera **20a** and the second camera **20b** which continuously photograph the anterior ocular segment Ea. In addition, the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit **100** repeatedly outputs the acquired anterior ocular segment images **D1** and **D2** to the pupil image detecting unit **102** and the relative position detecting unit **108**.

(65) The pupil image detecting unit **102** is used for face support determination. The pupil image detecting unit **102** repeatedly performs a processing for detecting a pupil image **116** (see FIG. 6), which is the image of the pupil of the subject eye E, from the anterior ocular segment images **D1** and **D2** input repeatedly from the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit **100**, for each of the anterior ocular segment images **D1** and **D2**. Unlike the processing for detecting the pupil image **116** performed by the relative position detecting unit **108** for auto-alignment, the processing for detecting the pupil image **116** by the pupil image detecting unit **102** is a simple processing because it requires only detection of the pupil image **116** within a range of the involuntary eye movement of the subject eye E.

(66) The pupil image detecting unit **102** functions as a first detecting unit **102a**, an estimating unit **102b**, a second detecting unit **102c**, and a repetition controlling unit **102d**.

(67) FIG. 6 is an explanatory drawing for describing the processing for detecting the pupil image **116** by the first detecting unit **102a**. As illustrated in FIG. 6 and previously described in FIG. 5, the first detecting unit **102a** detects the pupil image **116** from the anterior ocular segment image **D1** photographed by the first camera **20a**. Note that the first camera **20a** and the second camera **20b** may be designated such that the one that captures a clearer image of the anterior ocular segment Ea is designated as the “first camera **20a**”, and the other one is designated as the “second camera **20b**”.

(68) The first detecting unit **102a**, for example, performs known binarization processing, labeling processing, and filtering processing by circularity, on the full-size anterior ocular segment image **D1**. The labeling processing is processing for labeling consecutive white or black pixels in each pixel of the binarized anterior ocular segment image **D1** with the same label (assigning the same number). Filtering processing by circularity is processing for detecting regions where the circularity exceeds a predetermined value determined in advance from the anterior ocular segment image **D1** after the labeling processing. This allows the first detecting unit **102a** to detect the pupil image **116** from within the anterior ocular segment image **D1**, and outputs the result of detection indicating the shape and position of the pupil image **116** to the estimating unit **102b**.

(69) Note that the method of detecting the pupil image **116** from the anterior ocular segment image **D1** by the first detecting unit **102a** is not limited to the method described above (binarization processing, labeling processing, and filtering processing), and any known method may be used. In particular, a simple and detectable method is preferable.

(70) FIG. 7 is an explanatory drawing illustrating creation of a template **120** by the estimating unit **102b**. As illustrated in FIG. 7 and FIG. 5, the estimating unit **102b** creates the template **120** used for

detecting the pupil image **116** (template matching) in the anterior ocular segment image **D2** by the second detecting unit **102c** described later based on the result of detection of the pupil image **116** in the anterior ocular segment image **D1** by the first detecting unit **102a**.

(71) Specifically, the estimating unit **102b** estimates the shape of the pupil image **116** in the anterior ocular segment image **D2** based on the shape of the pupil image **116** in the anterior ocular segment image **D1** detected by the first detecting unit **102a** and creates shape information **120a** corresponding to the result of estimation.

(72) In addition, the estimating unit **102b** estimates a presence range **118** of the pupil image **116** in the anterior ocular segment image **D2** based on the position of the pupil image **116** in the anterior ocular segment image **D1** detected by the first detecting unit **102a** and creates presence range information **120b** corresponding to the result of estimation. The presence range **118** indicates a range in which the pupil image **116**, which moves in the anterior ocular segment image **D2** in response to the involuntary eye movement of the subject eye **E**, is present. In the illustration in FIG. 7 (as well as FIG. 8 described below), the presence range **118** is exaggerated compared to the actual one in order to prevent complication of the drawing.

(73) Here, the method of generating the presence range information **120b** is not limited. The positional relationship between the first camera **20a** and the second camera **20b** and the photographing magnifications (reproduction ratios) of the first camera **20a** and the second camera **20b**, are known. Therefore, the estimating unit **102b** can estimate the position of the pupil image **116** within the anterior ocular segment image **D2** based on the position of the pupil image **116** within the anterior ocular segment image **D1** detected by the first detecting unit **102a**. In addition, the degree to which the pupil image **116** is displaced within the anterior ocular segment image **D2** in response to the involuntary eye movement of the subject eye **E** can also be determined in advance by experiment or simulation. Therefore, the estimating unit **102b** can create the presence range information **120b** by estimating the presence range **118** based on the result of detection of the first detecting unit **102a**, the positional relationship between the first camera **20a** and the second camera **20b**, and the photographing magnifications thereof, and the amount of displacement of the pupil image **116** according to the involuntary eye movement of the subject eye **E**.

(74) Then, the estimating unit **102b** creates the template **120** including the shape information **120a** and the presence range information **120b**, and stores the template **120** in the memory **92**.

(75) FIG. 8 is an explanatory drawing for describing a processing for detecting a pupil image **116** from the anterior ocular segment image **D2** by a second detecting unit **102c**. As illustrated in FIG. 8 and FIG. 5, the second detecting unit **102c** detects the pupil image **116** from within the presence range **118** of the anterior ocular segment image **D2** by known template matching, based on the template **120** (shape information **120a** and presence range information **120b**) stored in the memory **92**. Specifically, the second detecting unit **102c** identifies the presence range **118** within the anterior ocular segment image **D2** based on the presence range information **120b** and detects the pupil image **116** having a shape corresponding to the shape information **120a** from within the presence range **118**.

(76) Instead of performing template matching, the second detecting unit **102c** may detect the pupil image **116** from within the presence range **118** in the anterior ocular segment image **D2**, by performing the processing for detecting the pupil image **116** similar to that in the first detecting unit **102a** described above.

(77) The repetition controlling unit **102d** repeatedly activates the first detecting unit **102a**, the estimating unit **102b**, and the second detecting unit **102c** each time when the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit **100** repeatedly acquires the anterior ocular segment images **D1** and **D2** from the first camera **20a** and the second camera **20b**.

(78) Accordingly, detection of the pupil image **116** from the anterior ocular segment image **D1** by the first detecting unit **102a**, creation of the template **120** by the estimating unit **102b**, and detection of the pupil image **116** from the anterior ocular segment image **D2** (presence range **118**) by the

second detecting unit **102c** are performed repeatedly.

(79) Returning to FIG. 5, the determining unit **104** performs the face support determination based on the results of detection repeatedly performed by the second detecting unit **102c**. Here, when the examinee's face is properly supported by the face supporting unit **12**, the movement of his or her face is almost suppressed. Therefore, even if the pupil image **116** within the anterior ocular segment image **D2** moves in the anterior ocular segment image **D2** in response to the involuntary eye movement of the subject eye **E**, it remains within the presence range **118** for a certain period of time. Conversely, when the examinee's face is not properly supported by the face supporting unit **12**, such as when the examinee's face is not in contact with the chin rest **12a**, movement of his or her face occurs. Thus, the state in which the pupil image **116** remains within the presence range **118** of the anterior ocular segment image **D2** does not continue for a certain period of time. Therefore, the determining unit **104** determines presence or absence of the movement of the face supported by the face supporting unit **12** for a certain period of time determined in advance based on the results of detection of repetition by the second detecting unit **102c**, to perform face support determination for determining whether or not the face is properly supported by the face supporting unit **12**.

(80) Specifically, the determining unit **104** determines whether the number of times of consecutive detections of the pupil image **116** (the number of consecutive times when the pupil image **116** is consecutively detected) from within the presence range **118** of the anterior ocular segment image **D2** reaches a predetermined number of times, based on the results of detection of repetition by the second detecting unit **102c**. In other words, the determining unit **104** determines whether the detection of the pupil image **116** from within the presence range **118** lasts (continues) for a certain period of time or more based on the results of detection of repetition by the second detecting unit **102c**.

(81) In a case where the detection of the pupil image **116** from within the presence range **118** continues for a certain period of time or more, the determining unit **104** determines that there is no movement of the examinee's face supported by the face supporting unit **12**. Thus, the determining unit **104** determines that the face is properly supported by the face supporting unit **12**. Conversely, in a case where detection of the pupil image **116** from within the presence range **118** does not continue for the certain period of time or more, the determining unit **104** determines that there is a movement of the examinee's face supported by the face supporting unit **12**, and thus determines that the face is not properly supported by the face supporting unit **12**.

(82) In a case where the determining unit **104** determines that the face is properly supported by the face supporting unit **12**, the result of determination is output to the relative position detecting unit **108** and the alignment controlling unit **110**. In a case where the determining unit **104** determines that the face is not properly supported by the face supporting unit **12**, the result of determination is output to the notification controlling unit **106**.

(83) FIG. 9 is an explanatory drawing illustrating an example of a display (notification) of warning information **124** by a monitor **18**. As illustrated in FIG. 9 and FIG. 5, the notification controlling unit **106** displays warning information **124** indicating that the face is not properly supported by the face supporting unit **12** on the monitor **18** when the result of determination from the determining unit **104** is input. This causes the warning information **124** to be reported to the examiner. Therefore, in this case, the notification controlling unit **106** and the monitor **18** function as the notifying unit of the present invention. A warning message may be output from a speaker (not illustrated) in place of displaying the warning information **124** by the monitor **18** or together with the displaying the warning information **124**.

(84) FIG. 10 is an explanatory drawing illustrating an example of notifying the examinee that the examinee's face is not properly supported by the face supporting unit **12**.

(85) As illustrated in FIG. 10 and FIG. 5, when the result of determination from the determining unit **104** is input, the notification controlling unit **106** drives the motorized lifting mechanism **12c** and moves, for example, a chin rest **12a** and a forehead fit **12b** up and down in the Y direction to

change the face supporting position by the chin rest **12a**, and so forth. This allows the examinee to be notified that the face is not properly supported by the face supporting unit **12**. Accordingly, in this case, the notification controlling unit **106** and the face supporting unit **12** function as the notifying unit of the present invention.

(86) [Auto-Alignment]

(87) Returning to FIG. **5**, the relative position detecting unit **108** and the alignment controlling unit **110** are used for auto-alignment and are operated by receiving an input of the result of determination from the determining unit **104**.

(88) The relative position detecting unit **108** detects the pupil image **116** (pupil region and pupil shape) from each of the anterior ocular segment images **D1** and **D2**, based on the anterior ocular segment images **D1** and **D2** input from the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit **100**, and identifies characteristic position of each pupil image **116** corresponding to the pupil center or the corneal apex. Next, based on the positions and photographing magnifications of the first camera **20a** and the second camera **20b**, and the characteristic position of each of the anterior ocular segment images **D1** and **D2**, the relative position detecting unit **108** calculates a relative position (3D position) of the subject eye **E** with respect to the measurement head **14** by a known method (see Japanese Patent Application Laid-Open No. 2013-248376). The relative position detecting unit **108** then outputs the result of calculation as the results of detection of the relative position of the subject eye **E** to the alignment controlling unit **110**.

(89) The processing for detecting the pupil images **116** from the anterior ocular segment images **D1** and **D2** by the relative position detecting unit **108** is precise processing which is required to accurately identify the characteristic positions described above, unlike the detection processing by the first detecting unit **102a** in the face support determination described above. The relative position detecting unit **108**, for example, binarizes the anterior ocular segment images **D1** and **D2**, and precisely calculates the relative position of the subject eye **E**, from the binarized anterior ocular segment images **D1** and **D2**.

(90) The alignment controlling unit **110** drives the motorized driving mechanism **17** based on the result of detection of the relative position of the subject eye **E** by the relative position detecting unit **108** to perform the auto-alignment of the measurement head **14** with respect to the subject eye **E**.

(91) [Acquisition of Ocular Characteristics]

(92) After completion of the auto-alignment, the ocular characteristics acquisition controlling unit **112** operates to acquire the ocular characteristics of the subject eye **E** (fundus photographic images and OCT images of the fundus **Ef**). Specifically, the ocular characteristics acquisition controlling unit **112** drives the fundus camera unit **14a** to acquire a fundus photographic image of the fundus **Ef**. In addition, the ocular characteristics acquisition controlling unit **112** drives the OCT optical system **80**, the OCT unit **14b**, and the image forming unit **94**, and so forth to acquire the OCT image of fundus **Ef**.

(93) [Operation of Ophthalmologic Device of First Embodiment]

(94) FIG. **11** is a flowchart showing a flow of processing for acquiring the ocular characteristics from the subject eye **E** by the ophthalmologic device **10** according to the first embodiment configured as described above, in particular, a flow of face support determination processing according to a method of controlling the ophthalmologic device **10** of the present invention. As illustrated in FIG. **11**, when the power of the ophthalmologic device **10** is turned on by the examiner or when a measurement start operation (capture operation) is performed at the operating unit **16**, the acquisition of the ocular characteristics of the subject eye **E** is started (Step **S1**).

(95) The general controlling unit **90** causes the first camera **20a** and the second camera **20b** to start continuous photographing of the anterior ocular segment **Ea** of the subject eye **E**. As a result, the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit **100** acquires anterior ocular segment images **D1** and **D2** from the first camera **20a** and the second camera **20b**, respectively, and outputs these anterior ocular segment images **D1** and **D2** to the pupil image detecting unit **102** (step **S2**, corresponding to

the step of acquiring the anterior ocular segment images of the present invention).

(96) When the anterior ocular segment images **D1** and **D2** are input to the pupil image detecting unit **102**, the first detecting unit **102a** performs, as illustrated in FIG. 6 described above, the binarization processing, labeling processing, and filtering processing on the anterior ocular segment image **D1** to detect the pupil image **116** from the anterior ocular segment image **D1** and output the results of detection of the position and the shape of the pupil image **116** to the estimating unit **102b** (Step **S3**).

(97) Next, as illustrated in FIG. 7 above, the estimating unit **102b** estimates the shape and presence range **118** of the pupil image **116** within the anterior ocular segment image **D2** based on the result of detection from the first detecting unit **102a** to create the template **120** (the shape information **120a** and the presence range information **120b**) (Step **S4**). Then, as illustrated in FIG. 8 above, the second detecting unit **102c** performs template matching based on the template **120** to detect the pupil image **116** from within the presence range **118** of the anterior ocular segment image **D2** (Step **S5**).

(98) In a case where the pupil image **116** is detected from within the presence range **118** of the anterior ocular segment image **D2**, the repetition controlling unit **102d** causes a series of processing from Step **S3** to Step **S6** described above to be repeatedly performed (Yes in Step **S6**, No in Step **S7**). In case where the pupil image **116** is not detected from within the presence range **118** of the anterior ocular segment image **D2**, the procedure proceeds to Step **S12** described below (No in Step **S6**). Steps **S3** to **S6** correspond to the pupil image detection step of the present invention.

(99) Until determined to be Yes in Step **S7** or No in Step **S6**, the repetition controlling unit **102d** causes the series of processing from Step **S3** to Step **S6** to be repeatedly performed, each time when the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit **100** repeatedly acquires the anterior ocular segment images **D1** and **D2** from the first camera **20a** and the second camera **20b**.

(100) Based on the results of detection repeatedly performed by the second detecting unit **102c**, in a case where the number of times of consecutive detections of the pupil image **116** from within the presence range **118** of the anterior ocular segment image **D2** reaches a predetermined number of times, that is, in a case where detection of the pupil image **116** continues for a certain period of time or more, the determining unit **104** determines that the face is properly supported by the face supporting unit **12** (Yes in Step **S7**, Step **S8**). Note that Step **S8**, together with step **S12** described below, corresponds to the determination step of the present invention. The determining unit **104** then outputs the result of determination that the face is properly supported by the face supporting unit **12** to the relative position detecting unit **108** and the alignment controlling unit **110**. Thus, the auto-alignment automatically starts, following the face support determination.

(101) The relative position detecting unit **108** detects the relative position of the subject eye **E** with respect to the measurement head **14** based on the anterior ocular segment images **D1** and **D2** input from the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit **100**, and outputs the result of detection to the alignment controlling unit **110** (Step **S9**). Accordingly, the alignment controlling unit **110** drives the motorized driving mechanism **17** based on the results of detection of the relative position of the subject eye **E** to perform the auto-alignment of the measurement head **14** with respect to the subject eye **E** (Step **S10**).

(102) When the auto-alignment is completed, the ocular characteristics acquisition controlling unit **112** drives the fundus camera unit **14a** to acquire a fundus photographic image of the fundus **Ef**, or drives the OCT optical system **80**, the OCT unit **14b**, the image forming unit **94**, and so forth to acquire the OCT image of the fundus **Ef**. Accordingly, the acquisition of the ocular characteristics of the subject eye **E** is completed (Step **S11**).

(103) On the other hand, in a case where the pupil image **116** is not detected by the second detecting unit **102c** from within the presence range **118** of the anterior ocular segment image **D2** (No, in Step **S6**), the determining unit **104** determines that the face is not properly supported by the face supporting unit **12** (Step **S12**). The determining unit **104** then outputs the result of

determination that the face is not properly supported by the face supporting unit **12** to the notification controlling unit **106**.

(104) Upon reception of the result of determination input from the determining unit **104**, the notification controlling unit **106** displays the warning information **124** on the monitor **18** or drives the motorized lifting mechanism **12c** to move the chin rest **12a** up and down in the Y direction as illustrated in FIG. **9** and FIG. **10** described above. Accordingly, the examiner and the examinee are notified that the examinee's face is not properly supported by the face supporting unit **12** (Step **S13**). The examiner then alerts the examinee so that the examinee's face is properly supported by the face supporting unit **12**, or adjusts the position of the chin rest **12a**, and so forth. Then, the series of processing from Step **S1** onwards is repeatedly performed.

Effects and Advantages of the Embodiment

(105) As described above, in this embodiment, whether the examinee's face is properly supported by the face supporting unit **12** can be determined based on the anterior ocular segment images **D1** and **D2** photographed by the stereo camera **20**. Therefore, the ocular characteristics of the subject eye **E** can be acquired in a state in which the examinee's face is properly supported by the face supporting unit **12**. This prevents the face from moving during the acquisition of the ocular characteristics of the subject eye **E**. Therefore, it is possible to prevent deterioration of the accuracy of the acquired ocular characteristics, or failure in acquisition of the ocular characteristics. In addition, since existing stereo cameras **20** can be used, face support determination can be performed with only software modifications. As a result, the ocular characteristics of the subject eye **E** can be acquired accurately and reliably.

(106) In addition, since the face support determination and the auto-alignment can be performed using the anterior ocular segment images **D1** and **D2** photographed by the first camera **20a** and the second camera **20b**, the processing of the face support determination and the processing of the auto-alignment (detection of the relative position of the subject eye **E**) can be performed in parallel.

Second Embodiment

(107) Next, the ophthalmologic device **10** according to the second embodiment will be described. The repetition controlling unit **102d** of the pupil image detecting unit **102** according to the first embodiment described above repeatedly activates the first detecting unit **102a**, the estimating unit **102b**, and the second detecting unit **102c**, each time when the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit **100** repeatedly acquires the anterior ocular segment images **D1** and **D2** from the first camera **20a** and the second camera **20b**. Accordingly, detection (template matching) of the pupil image **116** from the anterior ocular segment image **D1** by the first detecting unit **102a**, creation of the template **120** by the estimating unit **102b**, and detection of the pupil image **116** from the anterior ocular segment image **D2** by the second detecting unit **102c** are performed repeatedly.

(108) In contrast, in the second embodiment, detection of the pupil image **116** from the anterior ocular segment image **D2** for the second and subsequent times by the second detecting unit **102c** (template matching) is performed repeatedly by using the template **120** generated based on the anterior ocular segment image **D1** for the first time. Note that the ophthalmologic device **10** according to the second embodiment has the same basic configuration as the ophthalmologic device **10** according to the first embodiment described above, except that the functions of the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit **100** and the repetition controlling unit **102d** are different. Therefore, those having the same function or configuration as the first embodiment described above are designated by the same reference signs and description thereof will be omitted.

(109) In face support determination processing, the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit **100** according to the second embodiment performs: image acquisition processing for the first time for acquiring the anterior ocular segment images **D1** and **D2** from the first camera **20a** and the second camera **20b**; and image acquisition processing for the second and subsequent times for acquiring the anterior ocular segment image **D2** repeatedly from the second camera **20b**.

(110) The repetition controlling unit **102d** according to the second embodiment repeatedly activates

the second detecting unit **102c**, every time when the pupil image **116** is detected from within the presence range **118** of the anterior ocular segment image D2 by the second detecting unit **102c** until the determination by the determining unit **104** is completed.

(111) FIG. **12** is a flowchart showing a flow of processing for acquiring the ocular characteristics from the subject eye E by the ophthalmologic device **10** of the second embodiment, in particular, a flow of face support determination processing according to a method of controlling the ophthalmologic device **10** of the present invention. Note that processing from Step **S1** to Step **S7** and processing from Step **S8** onward are basically the same as those in the first embodiment illustrated in FIG. **11** described above, and thus description will be omitted.

(112) When the determination in Step **S7** is No, the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit **100** acquires an anterior ocular segment image D2 from the second camera **20b** and outputs the anterior ocular segment image D2 to the second detecting unit **102c** (Step **S7A**). In this case, the operation of the first camera **20a** may be stopped or may not be stopped.

(113) Next, the repetition controlling unit **102d** according to the second embodiment repeatedly activates the second detecting unit **102c**. Accordingly, the second detecting unit **102c** performs template matching based on the template **120** created by the estimating unit **102b** after the image acquisition processing for the first time, and detects the pupil image **116** from the anterior ocular segment image D2 acquired by the image acquisition processing for the second time (Steps **S5** and **S6**).

(114) Then, until the determination in Step **S7** is Yes or until the determination in Step **S6** is No, the processing in Step **S7A** by the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit **100** and the processing in Steps **S5** and **S6** by the second detecting unit **102c** are repeatedly performed.

(115) In this manner, in the second embodiment, after the processing of the image acquisition for the first time, the pupil images **116** can be detected from the anterior ocular segment images D2 acquired in the image acquisition processing for the second and subsequent times, based on the template **120** created by the estimating unit **102b**. Accordingly, in the face support determination processing for the second and subsequent times, it is possible to omit the acquisition of the anterior ocular segment image D1, the detection of the pupil image **116** from the anterior ocular segment image D1, and the creation of the template **120**. As a result, time required for face support determination processing is reduced in the second and subsequent times.

Third Embodiment

(116) FIG. **13** is a functional block diagram of an arithmetic controlling unit **22** of the ophthalmologic device **10** according to a third embodiment. In each of the embodiments described above, the notification controlling unit **106** performs a notification of the result of determination in a case where it is determined by the determining unit **104** that the examinee's face is not properly supported by the face supporting unit **12**. In contrast, in the ophthalmologic device **10** according to the third embodiment, in a case where the determining unit **104** determines that the examinee's face is not properly supported by the face supporting unit **12**, the face support determination processing is performed again after the face supporting position is changed by the chin rest **12a** or the like.

(117) As illustrated in FIG. **13**, the ophthalmologic device **10** according to the third embodiment has a configuration which is basically the same as that of the ophthalmologic device **10** of each of the embodiments described above, except that the general controlling unit **90** further functions as a supporting position change controlling unit **130** and a redetermination controlling unit **132**.

Therefore, those having the same function or configuration as each embodiment described above are designated by the same reference signs and description thereof will be omitted.

(118) FIG. **14** is a flowchart showing a flow of processing for acquiring the ocular characteristics from the subject eye E by an ophthalmologic device **10** according to the third embodiment, in particular, a flow of face support determination processing according to a method of controlling the ophthalmologic device **10** of the present invention. Note that the series of processing from step **S1** to step **S12** is basically the same as the processing in the second embodiment illustrated in FIG. **12**

described above, so the specific explanation will be omitted.

(119) As illustrated in FIG. 13 and FIG. 14, in a case where the determining unit **104** determines that the face is not properly supported by the face supporting unit **12** (Step **S12**), the supporting position change controlling unit **130** is activated. This supporting position change controlling unit **130** drives the motorized lifting mechanism **12c** to change the supporting position of the examinee's face by the face supporting unit **12**, for example, to change, the supporting position of the examinee's face upward in the Y direction (Step **S14**).

(120) For example, the supporting position change controlling unit **130** drives the motorized lifting mechanism **12c** to raise the face supporting position by the face supporting unit **12** by approximately 5 mm. Alternatively, the supporting position change controlling unit **130** monitors (detects) the position of the pupil image **116** in at least one of the anterior ocular segment images **D1** and **D2** acquired by the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit **100** and drives the motorized lifting mechanism **12c** to change the supporting position of the face supported by the face supporting unit **12** at a low speed upward in the Y direction, until the position of the pupil image **116** changes. In place of changing the supporting position of the examinee's face upward in the Y direction, it may be changed downward.

(121) In this manner, by changing the supporting position of the examinee's face by the face supporting unit **12**, in particular upwardly in the Y direction, the support of the examinee's face by the face supporting unit **12** may be changed from an improper state to a proper state, or the examinee can be alerted that the face is not properly supported by the face supporting unit **12**.

(122) In a case where the face supporting position by the face supporting unit **12** is changed, the redetermination controlling unit **132** controls each unit (the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit **100**, the pupil image detecting unit **102**, and the determining unit **104**) of the general controlling unit **90** to repeatedly perform the series of processing from the Steps **S1** to **S7A** described above. Accordingly, the face support determination processing described in the second embodiment described above is repeatedly performed. As in the first embodiment illustrated in FIG. 11 above, the series of processing from Step **S1** to Step **S7** described above may be repeatedly performed.

(123) From then onward until the determining unit **104** determines that the face is properly supported by the face supporting unit **12**, the series of processing from Step **S14**, from Step **S1** to Step **S7A** (Step **S7**) is repeatedly performed.

(124) In this manner, in the third embodiment, even in a case where the examinee's face is not properly supported by the face supporting unit **12**, the face support determination processing is repeatedly performed after changing the face supporting position by the face supporting unit **12**. Thus, the ophthalmologic device **10** can automatically proceed to the subsequent processing (Step **S9** to **S11**) without any operations performed by the examiner. Accordingly, the time and effort of the examiner can be alleviated.

Others

(125) In each of the embodiments described above, the stereo camera **20** (a first camera **20a** and a second camera **20b**) has been described as an example, but a plurality, three or more, of cameras may be used to photograph the subject eye E. In this case as well, the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit **100** acquires the anterior ocular segment image **D1** photographed by the first camera **20a** among the plurality of cameras and the anterior ocular segment image **D2** taken by one or more second cameras **20b** among the plurality of cameras repeatedly. In addition, the first detecting unit **102a** detects the pupil image **116** for each anterior ocular segment image **D1** photographed by the first camera **20a**. Furthermore, the estimating unit **102b** estimates the presence range **118** (creates the template **120**) for each anterior ocular segment image **D2** photographed by the one or more of the second cameras **20b**. Moreover, the second detecting unit **102c** detects the pupil image **116** from within the presence range **118** for each of the one or more anterior ocular segment images **D2**. Then, the determining unit **104** determines whether the number of times of

consecutive detections of the pupil image **116** from within the presence range **118** for each of one or more of the anterior ocular segment images **D2** has reached a predetermined number of times. (126) In each of the embodiments described above, the detection of the pupil image **116** for each of the anterior ocular segment images **D1** and **D2** by the pupil image detecting unit **102** and the face support determination by the determining unit **104** are performed based on the anterior ocular segment images **D1** and **D2** continuously photographed by the first camera **20a** and the second camera **20b**. However, the number of cameras used for the face support determination may be one. (127) In this case, the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit **100** repeatedly acquires the anterior ocular segment image **D1** or the anterior ocular segment image **D2** (hereinafter, referred to as a single anterior ocular segment image) continuously photographed by either one of the first camera **20a** and the second camera **20b**. The pupil image detecting unit **102** repeatedly detects the pupil image **116** for each single anterior ocular segment image. The determining unit **104** then performs a face support determination based on whether the state in which the position of the pupil image **116** within the single anterior ocular segment image remains in the range corresponding to the involuntary eye movement of the subject eye **E** (corresponding to the previously described presence range **118**) continues for a certain period of time. Accordingly, face support determination can be performed by using a single camera.

(128) In this case, the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit **100** may repeatedly acquire the observation image of the anterior ocular segment **Ea** from the imaging optical system **50** (corresponding to the anterior ocular segment observation system of the present invention) capable of continuously photographing the anterior ocular segment **Ea** through the objective lens **43**. In this case as well, the face support determination can be performed in the same manner as the case where either one of the first camera **20a** and the second camera **20b** is used.

(129) In each of the embodiments described above, the arithmetic controlling unit **22** is built in the measurement head **14**. However, it may be provided externally of the base **11** and the measurement head **14**, and so forth. In other words, the ophthalmologic device **10** of the present invention is also applicable to an apparatus for remote medical examination.

(130) In each of the embodiments described above, the acquisition of a fundus photographic image and an OCT image of the fundus **Ef** has been described as an example of the acquisition of ocular characteristics of the subject eye **E**. However, the present invention can also be applied to the ophthalmologic device **10** for acquiring various ocular characteristics such as an ocular refractive power, an intraocular pressure, the number of corneal endothelial cells, and corneal shape of the subject eye **E**.

EXPLANATION OF REFERENCE SIGNS

(131) **10** . . . ophthalmologic device **12** . . . face supporting unit **12a** . . . chin rest **12b** . . . forehead fit **12c** . . . motorized lifting mechanism **14** . . . measurement head **14a** . . . fundus camera unit **14b** . . . OCT unit **16** . . . operating unit **17** . . . motorized driving mechanism **18** . . . monitor **20** . . . stereo camera **20a** . . . first camera **20b** . . . second camera **22** . . . arithmetic controlling unit **30** . . . illumination optical system **43** . . . objective lens **50** . . . imaging optical system **70** . . . focusing optical system **80** . . . OCT optical system **90** . . . general controlling unit **100** . . . anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit **102** . . . pupil image detecting unit **102a** . . . first detecting unit **102b** . . . estimating unit **102c** . . . second detecting unit **102d** . . . repetition controlling unit **104** . . . determining unit **106** . . . notification controlling unit **108** . . . relative position detecting unit **110** . . . alignment controlling unit **112** . . . ocular characteristics acquisition controlling unit **116** . . . pupil image **118** . . . presence range **120** . . . template **120a** . . . shape information **120b** . . . presence range information **124** . . . warning information **D1, D2** . . . anterior ocular segment image **E** . . . subject eye **Ea** . . . anterior ocular segment **Ef** . . . fundus

Claims

1. An ophthalmologic device comprising: a face support configured to support a face of an examinee; processing circuitry configured as an anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit configured to repeatedly acquire an anterior ocular segment image of a subject eye of the face supported by the face support; the processing circuitry further configured as a pupil image detecting unit configured to detect a pupil image of the subject eye for each anterior ocular segment image based on the anterior ocular segment image repeatedly acquired by the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit; and the processing circuitry further configured as a determining unit configured to determine whether or not the face is properly supported by the face support based on a result of detection of the pupil image for each anterior ocular segment image by the pupil image detecting unit, wherein the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit repeatedly acquires anterior ocular segment images from a plurality of cameras configured to photograph the subject eye from different directions, and the processing circuitry is further configured as a first detecting unit configured to detect the pupil image from the anterior ocular segment image photographed by a first camera among the plurality of cameras; an estimating unit configured to estimate a presence range of the pupil image included in the anterior ocular segment image photographed by a second camera, which is different from the first camera among the plurality of cameras, the pupil image moving in response to involuntary eye movement of the subject eye, based on a result of detection by the first detecting unit; a second detecting unit configured to detect the pupil image from within the presence range of the anterior ocular segment image photographed by the second camera based on a result of estimation by the estimating unit; and a repetition controlling unit configured to repeatedly activate the first detecting unit, the estimating unit, and the second detecting unit each time when the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit repeatedly acquires the anterior ocular segment images, and the determining unit determines whether or not the face is properly supported by the face support based on results of detection repeatedly performed by the second detecting unit.
2. The ophthalmologic device according to claim 1, wherein the determining unit determines, based on the results of detection repeatedly performed by the second detecting unit, that the face is properly supported by the face support in a case where the detection of the pupil image in the presence range continues for a certain period of time, which is determined in advance, or more, and determines that the face is not properly supported by the face support in a case where the detection of the pupil image in the presence range does not continue for the certain period of time or more.
3. The ophthalmologic device according to claim 1, wherein the estimating unit creates a template indicating the presence range and a shape of the pupil image from the anterior ocular segment image photographed by the first camera based on the result of detection by the first detecting unit, and the second detecting unit detects the pupil image from within the presence range of the anterior ocular segment image photographed by the second camera by template matching based on the template created by the estimating unit.
4. The ophthalmologic device according to claim 1, wherein the processing circuitry is further configured as: an ocular characteristic acquiring unit configured to acquire ocular characteristics of the subject eye through an objective lens, an ophthalmologic device main body configured to accommodate the ocular characteristic acquiring unit; a relative movement mechanism configured to move the ophthalmologic device main body with respect to the subject eye; a relative position detecting unit configured to detect a relative position of the subject eye relative to the ophthalmologic device main body based on the anterior ocular segment image acquired by the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit; and an alignment controlling unit configured to drive the relative movement mechanism to perform alignment of the ophthalmologic device main body relative to the subject eye based on a result of detection by the relative position detecting unit.
5. The ophthalmologic device according to claim 1, comprising wherein the processing circuitry is further configured as a notifying unit configured to notify a result of determination by the determining unit in a case where the determining unit determines that the face is not properly

supported by the face support.

6. The ophthalmologic device according to claim 5, comprising a supporting position changing mechanism including a motor and configured to change a face supporting position by the face support, wherein the notifying unit drives the supporting position changing mechanism to change the supporting position.

7. The ophthalmologic device according to claim 1, comprising: a supporting position changing mechanism including a motor and configured to change a face supporting position by the face support; the processing circuitry further configured as a supporting position change controlling unit configured to drive the supporting position changing mechanism and change the face supporting position in a case where the determining unit determines that the face is not properly supported by the face support, and the processing circuitry further configured as a redetermination controlling unit configured to repeatedly activate the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit, the pupil image detecting unit, and the determining unit in a case where the face supporting position is changed by the supporting position changing mechanism.

8. An ophthalmologic device comprising: a face support configured to support a face of an examinee; processing circuitry configured as an anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit configured to repeatedly acquire an anterior ocular segment image of a subject eye of the face supported by the face support; the processing circuitry further configured as a pupil image detecting unit configured to detect a pupil image of the subject eye for each anterior ocular segment image based on the anterior ocular segment image repeatedly acquired by the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit; and the processing circuitry further configured as a determining unit configured to determine whether or not the face is properly supported by the face support based on a result of detection of the pupil image for each anterior ocular segment image by the pupil image detecting unit, wherein the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit performs: image acquisition processing for the first time for acquiring anterior ocular segment images from the first camera and the second camera which photograph the subject eye from directions different from each other; and image acquisition processing for the second and subsequent times for acquiring the anterior ocular segment image repeatedly from the second camera, and the processing circuitry is further configured as a first detecting unit configured to detect the pupil image from the anterior ocular segment image acquired by the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit from the first camera in the first image acquisition processing; an estimating unit configured to estimate a presence range of the pupil image included in the anterior ocular segment image acquired from the second camera by the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit, the pupil image moving in response to the involuntary eye movement of the subject eye, based on a result of detection by the first detecting unit; a second detecting unit configured to detect the pupil image from within the presence range of the anterior ocular segment image acquired by the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit from the second camera based on a result of estimation by the estimating unit; and a repetition controlling unit configured to repeatedly activate the second detecting unit each time when the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit repeatedly acquires the anterior ocular segment image from the second camera in the image acquisition processing for the second and subsequent times, and the determining unit determines whether or not the face is properly supported by the face support based on results of detection repeatedly performed by the second detecting unit.

9. The ophthalmologic device according to claim 8, wherein the determining unit determines, based on the results of detection repeatedly performed by the second detecting unit, that the face is properly supported by the face support in a case where the detection of the pupil image in the presence range continues for a certain period of time, which is determined in advance, or more, and determines that the face is not properly supported by the face support in a case where the detection of the pupil image in the presence range does not continue for the certain period of time or more.

10. The ophthalmologic device according to claim 8, wherein the estimating unit creates a template

indicating the presence range and a shape of the pupil image from the anterior ocular segment image photographed by the first camera based on the result of detection by the first detecting unit, and the second detecting unit detects the pupil image from within the presence range of the anterior ocular segment image photographed by the second camera by template matching based on the template created by the estimating unit.

11. The ophthalmologic device according to claim 8, wherein the processing circuitry is further configured as: an ocular characteristic acquiring unit configured to acquire ocular characteristics of the subject eye through an objective lens, an ophthalmologic device main body configured to accommodate the ocular characteristic acquiring unit; a relative movement mechanism configured to move the ophthalmologic device main body with respect to the subject eye; a relative position detecting unit configured to detect a relative position of the subject eye relative to the ophthalmologic device main body based on the anterior ocular segment image acquired by the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit; and an alignment controlling unit configured to drive the relative movement mechanism to perform alignment of the ophthalmologic device main body relative to the subject eye based on a result of detection by the relative position detecting unit.

12. The ophthalmologic device according to claim 8, wherein the processing circuitry is further configured as a notifying unit configured to notify a result of determination by the determining unit in a case where the determining unit determines that the face is not properly supported by the face support.

13. The ophthalmologic device according to claim 12, comprising a supporting position changing mechanism including a motor and configured to change a face supporting position by the face support, wherein the notifying unit drives the supporting position changing mechanism to change the supporting position.

14. The ophthalmologic device according to claim 8, comprising: a supporting position changing mechanism including a motor and configured to change a face supporting position by the face support; the processing circuitry further configured as a supporting position change controlling unit configured to drive the supporting position changing mechanism and change the face supporting position in a case where the determining unit determines that the face is not properly supported by the face support, and the processing circuitry further configured as a redetermination controlling unit configured to repeatedly activate the anterior ocular segment image acquiring unit, the pupil image detecting unit, and the determining unit in a case where the face supporting position is changed by the supporting position changing mechanism.

15. A method of controlling an ophthalmologic device comprising: an anterior ocular segment image acquisition step of repeatedly acquiring an anterior ocular segment image of a subject eye of a face supported by a face support configured to support the face of an examinee; a pupil image detection step of detecting a pupil image of the subject eye for each anterior ocular segment image based on the anterior ocular segment image repeatedly acquired by the anterior ocular segment image acquisition step; and a determination step of determining whether or not the face is properly supported by the face support based on a result of detection of the pupil image for each anterior ocular segment image by the pupil image detection step, wherein the anterior ocular segment image acquisition step repeatedly acquires anterior ocular segment images from a plurality of cameras configured to photograph the subject eye from different directions, and the pupil image detection step includes: a first detecting step of detecting the pupil image from the anterior ocular segment image photographed by a first camera among the plurality of cameras; estimating a presence range of the pupil image included in the anterior ocular segment image photographed by a second camera, which is different from the first camera among the plurality of cameras, the pupil image moving in response to involuntary eye movement of the subject eye, based on a result of detection by the detecting; a second detecting step of detecting the pupil image from within the presence range of the anterior ocular segment image photographed by the second camera based on a result of estimating; and repeatedly activating the first detecting step, the estimating, and the second

detecting step each time when the anterior ocular segment image acquisition step repeatedly acquires the anterior ocular segment images, and the determination step determines whether or not the face is properly supported by the face support based on results of detection repeatedly performed by the second detecting step.

16. A method of controlling an ophthalmologic device comprising: an anterior ocular segment image acquisition step of repeatedly acquiring an anterior ocular segment image of a subject eye of a face supported by a face support configured to support the face of an examinee; a pupil image detection step of detecting a pupil image of the subject eye for each anterior ocular segment image based on the anterior ocular segment image repeatedly acquired by the anterior ocular segment image acquisition step; and a determination step of determining whether or not the face is properly supported by the face support based on a result of detection of the pupil image for each anterior ocular segment image by the pupil image detection step, wherein the anterior ocular segment image acquisition step performs: image acquisition processing for the first time for acquiring anterior ocular segment images from the first camera and the second camera which photograph the subject eye from directions different from each other; and image acquisition processing for the second and subsequent times for acquiring the anterior ocular segment image repeatedly from the second camera, and the pupil image detecting step includes: a first detecting step to detect the pupil image from the anterior ocular segment image acquired by the anterior ocular segment image acquisition step from the first camera in the first image acquisition processing; estimating a presence range of the pupil image included in the anterior ocular segment image acquired from the second camera by the anterior ocular segment image acquisition step, the pupil image moving in response to the involuntary eye movement of the subject eye, based on a result of detection by the first detecting step; a second detecting step to detect the pupil image from within the presence range of the anterior ocular segment image acquired by the anterior ocular segment image acquisition step from the second camera based on a result of estimation by the estimating; and repeatedly activating the second detecting step each time when the anterior ocular segment image acquisition step repeatedly acquires the anterior ocular segment image from the second camera in the image acquisition processing for the second and subsequent times, and the determination step determines whether or not the face is properly supported by the face support based on results of detection repeatedly performed by the second detecting step.
